

CRAFT ALMANAC

Brand Directions

Round 1 — three worlds for one almanac



Prepared June 2026 · Display typefaces shown as stand-ins; recommended faces named inside.

An identity for a platform, entered through a map.

Craft Almanac is becoming more than the map: pages for every material, project, and place that bring materials together, and content that empowers people to make things with their local environments. Makers and foragers first; students second. Contemporary and compelling, never antique pastiche.

DECIDED

Expressive display + quiet text · original SVG illustration + the data as art · a seasonal living palette over an ink-and-paper core · voice between knowledgeable friend and lyrical almanac.

AVOID

Compelling, never
Twee / cottagecore · institutional beige · rustic kitsch.

CONSTANTS

Permission colors stay unmistakable (they carry safety meaning) · ethics language stays prominent · everything compiles to CSS variables, SVG, and font files — no build step.

HOW TO READ ROUND 1

Three directions, four pages each: concept + wordmark, color, type, applied UI. Then a side-by-side, risks, and the decisions I need from you.

DIRECTION I

Specimen Modern

The field journal, gallery-grade.

Herbarium plates, specimen labels, and survey instruments, composed with contemporary museum restraint. Everything is pinned, numbered, and beautiful because it is precise. The map reads as a scientific instrument you are trusted to hold.

MOTIFS

Hairline rules. Specimen numbers. Letterspaced capitals. Pinned drawings on generous paper.



Elderberry



Morel



Oak + gall

CRAFT ALMANAC

MATERIAL MAPS OF THE UNITED STATES · EST. 2026

VOICE SAMPLE (POPUP / MARGIN NOTE)

Elderberry -- *Sambucus canadensis*. Gather only the fully ripe umbels; leave the stems standing for the birds. Allowed here: one gallon per person per day.

NAMING NOTE

Craft Almanac holds in all three worlds. If this direction leads, natural extensions are mastheads for sections: The Ink Pages, The Field Table, Projects in Season.



Allowed



Permit



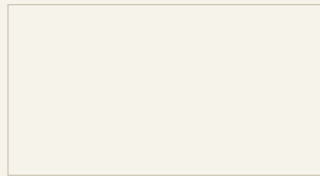
Prohibited



Unknown

Permission markers in this language (colors constant across directions)

A stable ink-and-paper core; one room, repainted by the season.



Paper
#F6F3EA core



Ink
#211F1A core



Graphite
#5B5850 core



Hairline
#CFC9B8 core



Thread
#6F8F3F core



SPRING

#6F8F3F fiddlehead



SUMMER

#8E3B55 bramble



AUTUMN

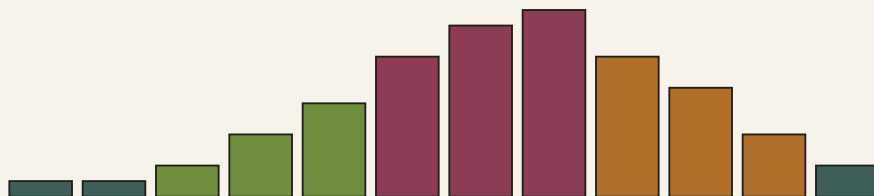
#B06F2B hickory



WINTER

#3E5E5A juniper

Mechanics: the accent variable rotates on the solstices and equinoxes; markers, histogram emphasis, links, and section mastheads inherit it. Paper and ink never move, so the site stays itself. Each seasonal accent is contrast-checked against paper and ink; permission-status colors are exempt from rotation and never reused decoratively.



The seasonal availability chart wearing all four accents at once — the data as art.

P E R S I M M O N

Diospyros virginiana — set letterspaced, numbered, and pinned

DISPLAY	Fraunces (display) or GT Alpina	Mastheads, species names, mode titles
TEXT	Source Serif 4	Guides, notes, almanac entries
UI	Inter	Controls, filters, buttons
LABELS	IBM Plex Mono	Specimen numbers, coordinates, data

Deck settings are stand-ins from available system faces; the named faces above are the recommendation to license/serve.

Reading sample. Gather only where the rules allow, and only what the patch can spare. The almanac will tell you what is ripe, where harvest is permitted, and which projects the week makes possible: ink from oak galls, a basket from willow, a pie from the field edge.

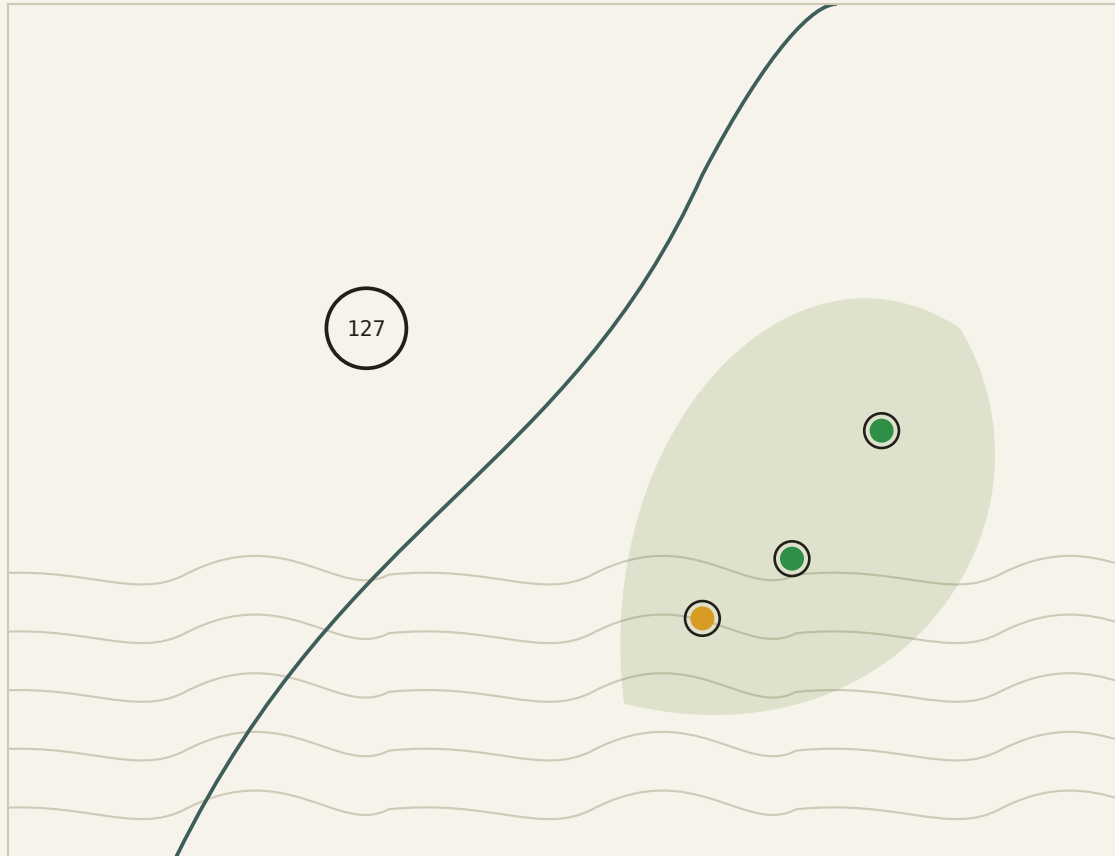
ELDERBERRY

Sambucus canadensis · No. 027

ALLOWED1 gallon / person / day — Shenandoah compendium

JFMA MJJASOND

Type system at work: the map popup



Basemap treatment study: paper terrain, hairline contours, seasonal river, public-land wash, this direction's markers.

ILLUSTRATION LANGUAGE



Grows into the item-page system: one drawing per material.

PROJECT CARD

OAK GALL INK

Galls, rusty iron, rain water, patience. A project page brings three map materials together with steps, season, and the rules for each.

● GATHER IN: OCT — DEC • MAKES: 1 BOTTLE

DIRECTION II

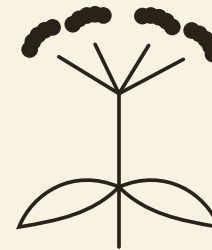
The Living Almanac

A book that knows what week it is.

The almanac itself becomes the identity: mastheads, week strips, marginalia, sun-and-season dials. The palette turns with the calendar so October and April are different rooms in the same house. Lyrical, generous, alive.

MOTIFS

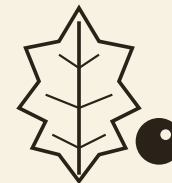
Masthead rules. A gold thread. Week-of strips. Margin notes in italic. Season dials.



Elderberry



Morel



Oak + gall

Craft Almanac

Seasonal maps for making with place

VOICE SAMPLE (POPUP / MARGIN NOTE)

Week of June 10 -- elderflower gives way to green fruit, and mulberries drop on warm sidewalks. Pick what you will use tonight; the season is long.

NAMING NOTE

Craft Almanac holds in all three worlds. If this direction leads, natural extensions are mastheads for sections: The Ink Pages, The Field Table, Projects in Season.



Allowed



Permit



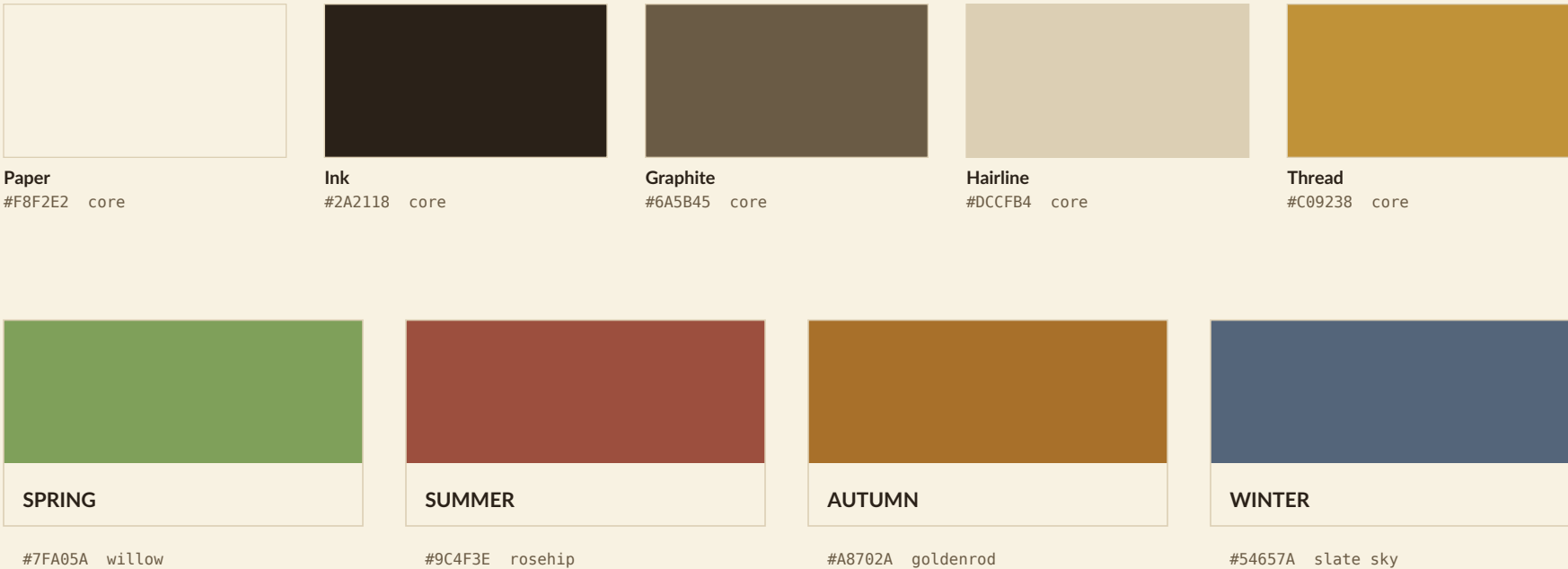
Prohibited



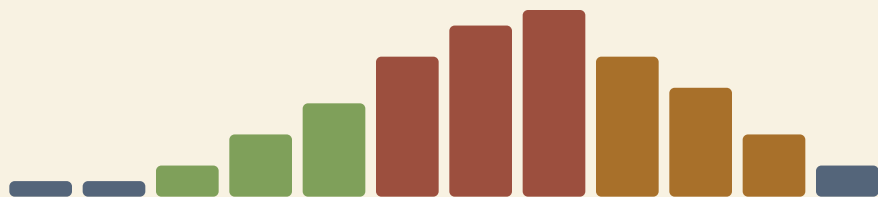
Unknown

Permission markers in this language (colors constant across directions)

A stable ink-and-paper core; one room, repainted by the season.



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The seasonal availability chart wearing all four accents at once — the data as art.

Persimmon, after frost

Headlines read like entries; the season writes the margins

DISPLAY	Instrument Serif Italic or Editorial New	Mastheads, species names, mode titles
TEXT	Lora	Guides, notes, almanac entries
UI	Lato or Karla	Controls, filters, buttons
LABELS	Lato SmallCaps	Specimen numbers, coordinates, data

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Reading sample. Gather only where the rules allow, and only what the patch can spare. The almanac will tell you what is ripe, where harvest is permitted, and which projects the week makes possible: ink from oak galls, a basket from willow, a pie from the field edge.

Elderberry

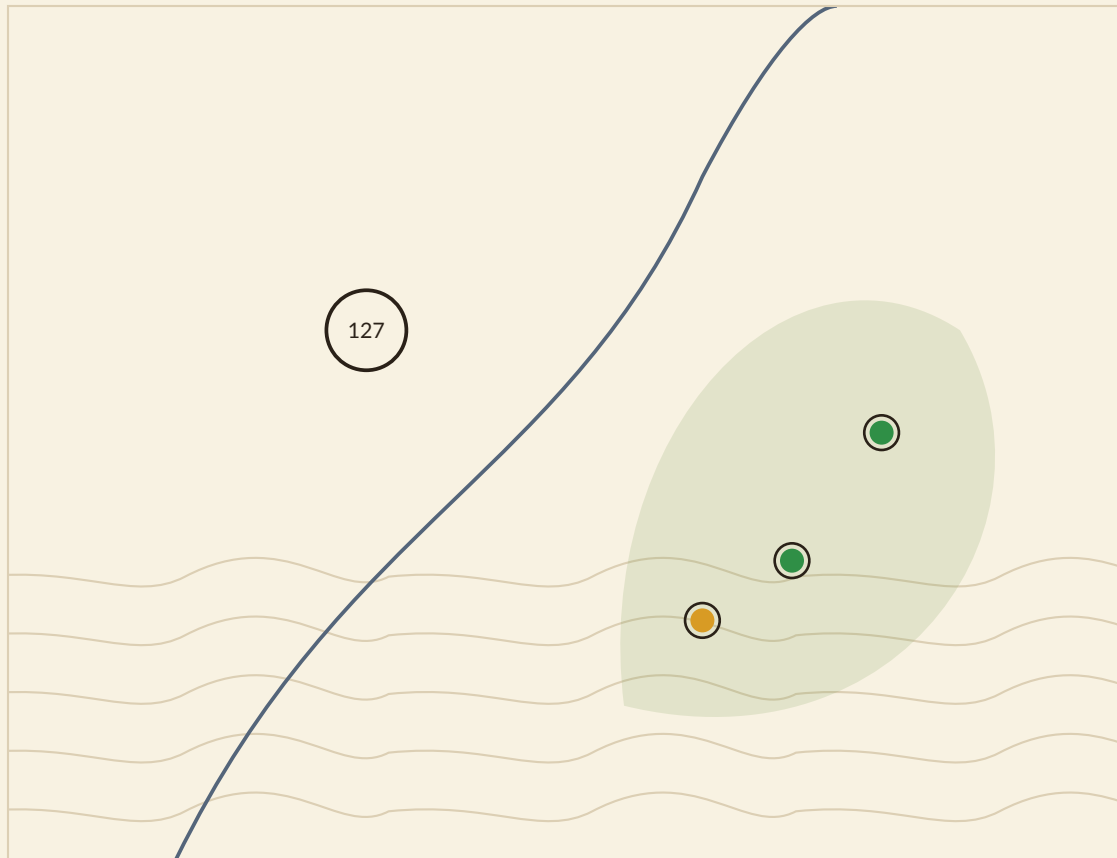
Sambucus canadensis — ripe mid-July to September

ALLOWED

1 gallon / person / day — Shenandoah compendium

JFMA MJJASOND

Type system at work: the map popup



Basemap treatment study: paper terrain, hairline contours, seasonal river, public-land wash, this direction's markers.

ILLUSTRATION LANGUAGE



Grows into the item-page system: one drawing per material.

PROJECT CARD

Oak gall ink

Galls, rusty iron, rain water, patience. A project page brings three map materials together with steps, season, and the rules for each.

● GATHER IN: OCT — DEC • MAKES: 1 BOTTLE

DIRECTION III

Forage Press

Folk craft with poster confidence.

The folk register pushed hard into now: modern woodcut illustration, flat decisive color, woodtype-scale headlines. A print shop for people who make things. Avoids kitsch with geometry and restraint, never distressing.

MOTIFS

Chunky rules. Two-color cuts. Print-shop ornaments. Instructional plates like recipe cards.



Elderberry



Morel



Oak + gall

CRAFT ALMANAC

MAPS + MATERIALS + PROJECTS — MADE WITH PLACE

VOICE SAMPLE (POPUP / MARGIN NOTE)

TAKE A LITTLE. LEAVE THE REST. Elderberries are ripe along the field edge -- one gallon a day is the rule here, and the recipe for ink is on the back of this card.

NAMING NOTE

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Allowed



Permit



Prohibited



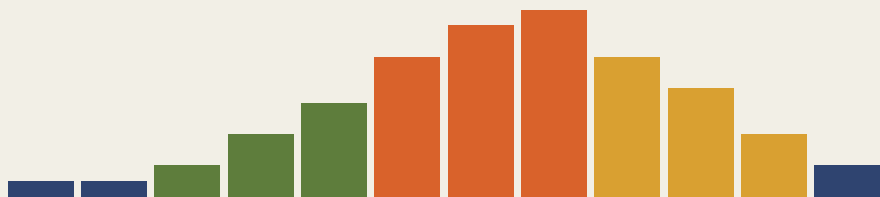
Unknown

Permission markers in this language (colors constant across directions)

A stable ink-and-paper core; one room, repainted by the season.



Mechanics: the accent variable rotates on the solstices and equinoxes; markers, histogram emphasis, links, and section mastheads inherit it. Paper and ink never move, so the site stays itself. Each seasonal accent is contrast-checked against paper and ink; permission-status colors are exempt from rotation and never reused decoratively.



The seasonal availability chart wearing all four accents at once — the data as art.

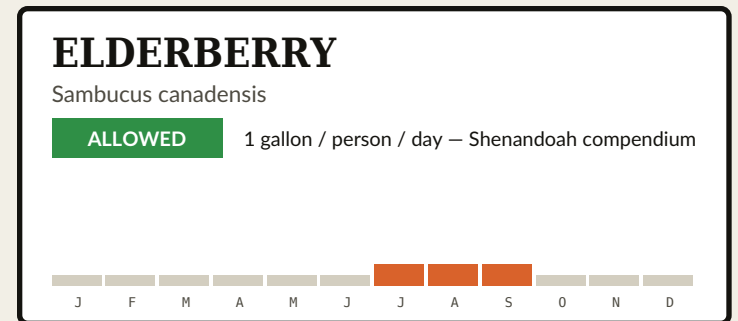
PERSIMMON

Woodtype scale, modern fit — headlines you can read across a room

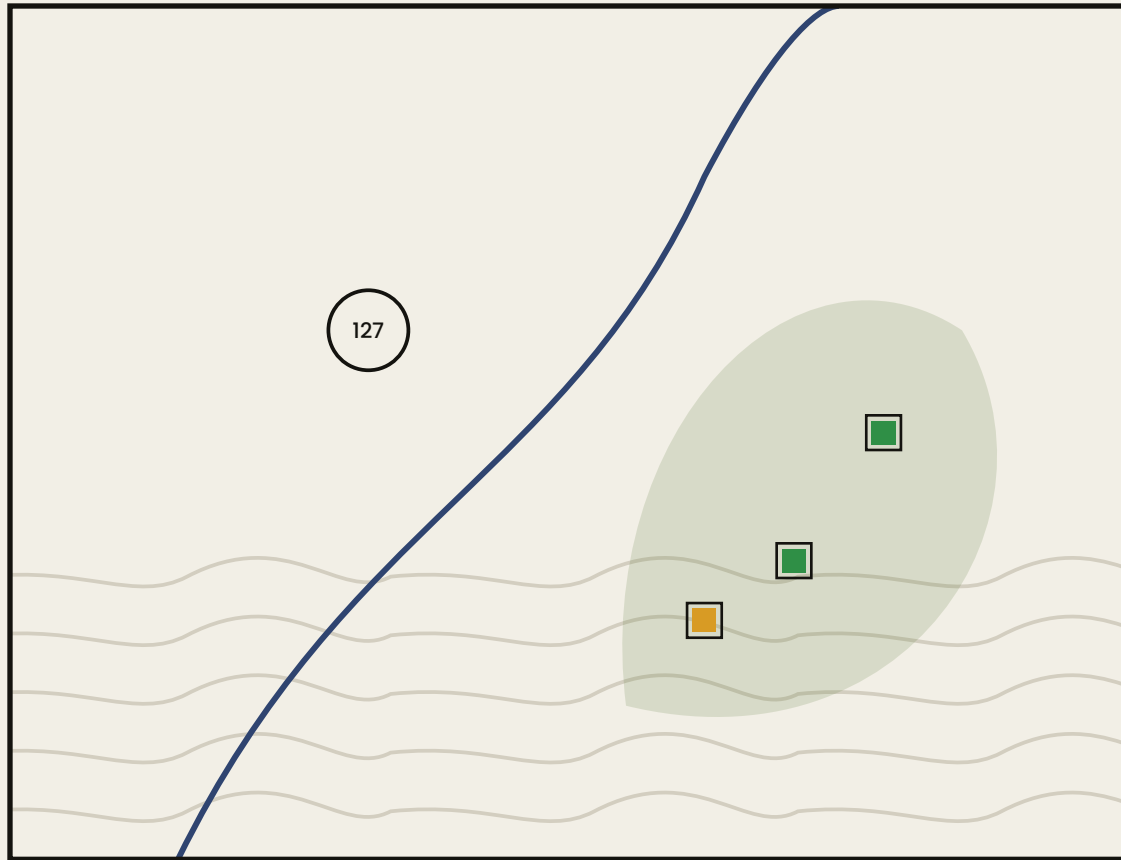
DISPLAY	Archivo Black or a licensed woodtype revival	Mastheads, species names, mode titles
TEXT	Bricolage Grotesque or Lato	Guides, notes, almanac entries
UI	Bricolage Grotesque	Controls, filters, buttons
LABELS	Poppins Medium	Specimen numbers, coordinates, data

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Reading sample. Gather only where the rules allow, and only what the patch can spare. The almanac will tell you what is ripe, where harvest is permitted, and which projects the week makes possible: ink from oak galls, a basket from willow, a pie from the field edge.



Type system at work: the map popup



Basemap treatment study: paper terrain, hairline contours, seasonal river, public-land wash, this direction's markers.

ILLUSTRATION LANGUAGE



Grows into the item-page system: one drawing per material.

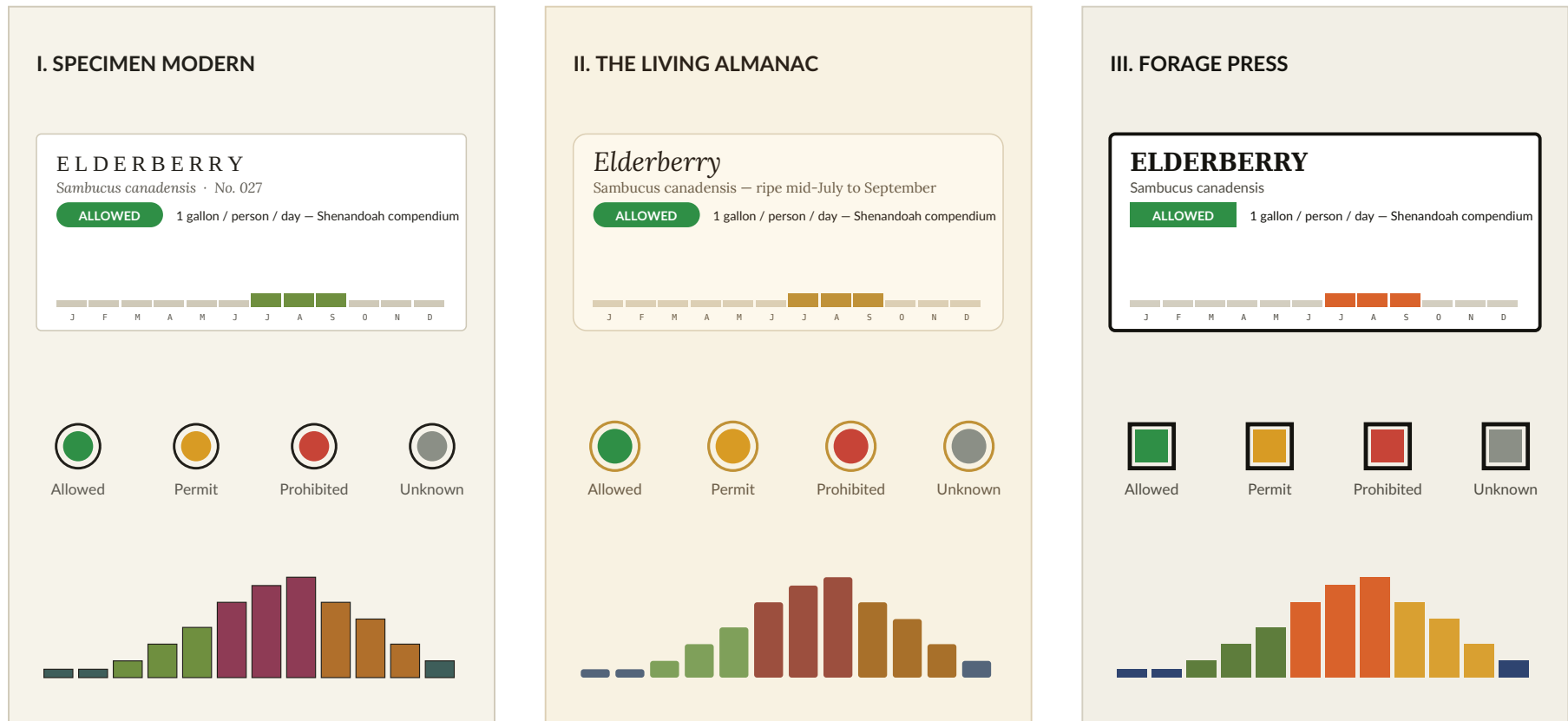
PROJECT CARD

OAK GALL INK

Galls, rusty iron, rain water, patience. A project page brings three map materials together with steps, season, and the rules for each.

● GATHER IN: OCT — DEC • MAKES: 1 BOTTLE

SIDE BY SIDE – THE SAME POPUP, THREE WORLDS



Constants in every direction: permission colors and their meanings; the seasonal histogram as a first-class object; specimen labels carrying source citations; plain-spoken safety lines. The directions differ in temperature: I is studied, II is alive, III is loud.

HONEST RISKS & WHAT EACH DIRECTION MUST PROVE

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--|
| I. Specimen Modern | May read cool or studied where the brief asks for invitation; warmth must come from voice and color. |
| II. The Living Almanac | The lyric register can tip precious; safety and rules must stay plain-spoken and visually firm. |
| III. Forage Press | Boldest departure; must hold classroom credibility -- the text layer carries the rigor. |
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SHARED CONSTRAINTS HONORED BY ALL THREE

Everything shown compiles to CSS variables, SVG assets, and licensed web fonts on the existing no-build static site. Mapbox basemap restyling happens once per direction in Studio. The seasonal rotation is a four-value variable swap on solstices and equinoxes. Permission-status colors were left untouched in all three palettes and pass contrast on every season's paper.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

Round 1 decisions

- 1 Which world? Pick a direction to lead — or name the hybrid (e.g., II's seasonal soul with I's specimen rigor).
 - 2 Wordmark energy: letterspaced caps, living italic, or woodtype? This sets the masthead for every future page.
 - 3 What did a direction get right that the winner should borrow? Steal freely across the three.
 - 4 Anything here that contradicts how you teach with the site? Flag it now, before Round 2 deepens the winner.
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THEN

Round 2 deepens the chosen direction: full palette with all four seasons applied, real licensed typefaces, the illustration system drawn properly in SVG, key screens (map, item page, project guide), and a Mapbox style. Then a live prototype on a design branch — the map wearing it for real.